that it would be cool for us to copy his act.

So Wayne takes a wicket – I forget whose it was; he got five that day. He looks at me standing at short fine leg, and he starts to do his Batista impression. Naturally, I followed suit. As we were running towards each other to celebrate as a group, I heard one of the senior players say to Wayne, 'Don't be like Gibbs. Just be yourself.'

Personally, I've never understood that kind of thinking. Here Wayne and I had planned a little fun celebration, and it was frowned on. Ag, I just told Wayne to celebrate in whatever way he wanted. I'm tired of seeing guys on a cricket field who look like they're not really enjoying themselves.

So, ja, for me the game has always been about entertainment. Have I given cricket fans their hard-earned money's worth? In an MTN40 match – these are 40-over games – against the Dolphins in early 2010, I scored a free-flowing 121 off 98 balls to help us post a game-winning 300/3 (young prospect Stiaan van Zyl also hit a 100 for us). After the game, one of the youngsters in the Dolphins team came up to me and said, 'Great innings, Hersch. Hey, you're still my favourite player.' That made me feel really good and that's exactly what I'm talking about regarding what I have set out to do. This comment came from a fellow player and not a fan, but it illustrates what I mean when I say I want to entertain. I want people to remember me for the kind of innings I play – not for what my damn average is.

For me, it's always about putting on a decent show. I mean, I'm a showman. I'm the first to admit it. I love the stage and I love entertaining people. I was born to do it. If I had tried to be selfish and batted just to make my numbers look good, I would never have played the kind of cricket that people have come to enjoy from me. I'm about to start quoting Frank Sinatra. Somebody stop me …